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Applied AI Team

Anthropic

San Francisco, CA

Dear Anthropic Hiring Team,

The FDE role requires someone who can build production AI systems, own the customer relationship while building them, and make the architecture legible to the enterprise stakeholders who need to trust it. That combination is rare because most careers stay on one side of the line: you are either the engineer or the advisor. My career has asked me to be both simultaneously, on the same accounts, often in the same week. I have played all three parts of this role, SA, PM, and engineer, often on the same engagement, and the fluency that comes from holding all three at once is exactly what enterprise customers expect from an FDE.

At Thoughtful AI, the role kept expanding because no one else could hold all three functions simultaneously, especially at a small company at that time. I started as Solutions Architect, became the person who directed Forward Deployed Engineers across 18 concurrent implementations in 7 different countries as Lead TPM, and directly contributed to the production systems those engineers deployed. The **96% pre-sales conversion rate** came from the same place as the **63% ARR contribution**: being the person who understood the customer's actual workflow deeply enough combined with the technical ability to spec it, build it, test it, and explain it. I built Thoughtful's first production GenAI system, a hybrid-RAG eligibility verification architecture achieving **95% accuracy within 2 days** on live billing workflows. I wrote the custom Python pipelines pulling agent execution logs from S3 that shipped as a core customer analytics product. These were not separate tracks running in parallel. They were the same job, delivering value to customers.

At Smarter Technologies, I built an internal **22-skill, 5-agent Claude Code platform** with pre/post tool-use hooks deployed org-wide via Cowork, achieving a **93% tool approval rating** in the first 3 weeks, while simultaneously running **\$31.8M in active healthcare pipeline** as a director of solutions engineering. I was also the person walking IT security teams through the architecture during HIPAA and BAA reviews, the person presenting to CISOs, and the primary technical contact for enterprise procurement across 61 active accounts. That combination, engineer and explainer in one person, is what FDEs bring to Anthropic's enterprise customers every day. The **943 commits and 500+ PRs** happened at the same time as the security reviews and discovery workshops, not instead of them.

My personal site runs a production agent built on the Anthropic SDK. It leverages tool use, specialized sub-agents, and document search over copious amounts of career content I've written. This is the same kind of Claude-native architecture I would be helping enterprise customers design. It is at danielmathieson.com if you want to see it before we talk! For a review of all the roles I've considered at Anthropic, you can navigate to <https://www.danielmathieson.com/refer/f3a8c1d94e72>.

When Thoughtful AI shut down within Smarter Technologies, I was retained as one of **15% kept** and the only non-Product/Engineering person. The PE firm made a specific exception. That happened because of the ability to take genuinely complex AI systems and make them legible to the people who need to adopt them: from an IT security leader reviewing an integration architecture to a CFO evaluating workflow ROI. I've been able to build

credibility in these arenas based on my technical acumen and ability to deliver solutions that not only deliver value to customers but also helps to explain that value. Those are the capabilities I want to bring into the field for Anthropic's enterprise customers, and I would welcome a conversation about how they fit the FDE role.

Sincerely,

Dan Mathieson

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